

Did the IMF confirm the developers?

A developers' claim, tested against the IMF report and Eurostat

THE CLAIM

“The IMF’s assessment of the Maltese housing market confirms what the Malta Developers Association...”

Malta Developers Association, release of 8 February 2026

“...for several years.” On the IMF’s 2025 Article IV report on Malta.

We read the IMF report and the MDA’s release in full.

VERDICT

LARGELY SUPPORTED

*Sound on valuation;
risks left out.*

SUPPORTED

LARGELY
SUPPORTED

NOT
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

–10.7%

Incomes grew faster than prices

Eurostat price-to-income ratio, 2015–2024; now below its long-term average.

“Aligned”

IMF: ratios “stable”

Prices “aligned with fundamentals”; weakening “currently low”.

72%

Banks tied to property

Share of private loans; the IMF calls it “a vulnerability”.

6.0%

Affordability not assessed

Overburdened by housing costs: 1.1% (2015) to 2.9% (2022); about 6% since a 2023 series break.

+59%

MDA’s own study disagrees

Prices since 2017; as reported, faster than incomes.

FAIR TO SAY

The statement is right about what the IMF said on valuation and stability. It leaves out the IMF’s warnings on banks and fast price growth.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ The release as first published.

☐ The MDA-commissioned study.

☐ How its price-to-income is measured.

☐ Affordability for renters.